Maharaj, Keshav RSA

South Africa M · Left Orthodox · **vs left-handers**

BALLS	WICKETS	ECONOMY	BOWLING AVG
3,806	64	3.5	34.8

STRIKE RATE	AVG SPEED	AVG LENGTH	ROUND THE WKT
59.5	82.0 kph P99 90.3	4.31 m Short 0%	17% LHB 17% · RHB 96%

Scouting Summary

COMMON THEMES

- Left Orthodox, averaging 82.0 kph (up to 90.3).
- Typical length is **4-5m** (their good length); median 4.3 m.
- Stock ball is **full wide outside off, turning in, drifting away, passing outside off** (34% of deliveries).
- Goes round the wicket 17% of the time against left-handers.
- **Round the wicket** he shifts his pitching line from wide of 6th to stumps.
- Turns it 4.6° on average; 37% of balls turn ≥5°.

BIGGEST THREATS

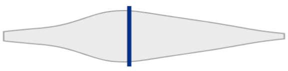
- Most dangerous length is **Good Length** (16 wkts, 1.9% adjusted strike).
- Danger pitching line: **4th stump**.
- Takes 38% of wickets pitching **full wide outside off**, over the wicket.
- Beats the bat 6.6% of tracked balls (false-shot 14.2%).
- Most likely to dismiss you **caught** (67% of wickets).
- 28% of catches are behind the wicket (keeper / slips / gully); most often to midwicket: deep, square leg: short leg, keeper.
- Very repeatable with his length — using your feet to change his length is more effective than waiting for a loose ball.

AREAS TO EXPLOIT

- Concedes most runs pitching **full wide outside off** (35% of runs).
- Away from good length, the wicket threat drops off — look to score in the less-productive lengths.
- Most of his runs leak square/through the off side (45%) — his main scoring release.
- Cash in when he goes **good length wide outside off** (economy 4.5, beats the bat only 20%).

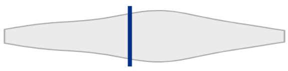
Bowling Fingerprint

Release height
P51



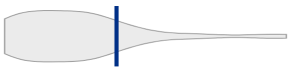
2.07 m · vs left-arm spin

Crease width
P37



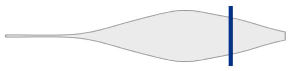
79 cm · vs left-arm spin

Crease variation
P82



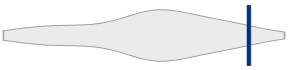
±22 cm · vs left-arm spin

Turn
P79



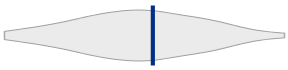
4.4° · vs spin bowlers

Drift
P93



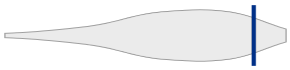
2.3° · vs spin bowlers

Bounce
P59



4.4° · vs spin bowlers

Repeatability
P91



±0.9 m · vs spin bowlers

*Percentile within same-type peers (grey = the peer distribution, line = this bowler). Release/crease vs hand × pace/spin; movement/speed/repeatability vs pace/spin. Release & speed are modern-era (2017+ / partial). **Crease variation** = how much he moves his release point sideways across the crease from ball to ball (within his main angle): a high percentile = he varies where he lets the ball go a lot, a low percentile = he releases from the same spot every ball. **Repeatability** = length consistency over his stock-length band (2–11 m, so deliberate yorkers and bouncers don't count as poor control): a high percentile = tighter, more metronomic lengths than peers; a low percentile = he varies his length more. A marker at the very edge = he sits beyond the typical peer range on that trait.*

Current Form (last 5 Tests · 2025-06-11 → 2025-11-22)

He's around his career level lately (avg 25 last 5 vs 30 career).

Window	Balls	Wkts	Avg	Econ	SR	False%	Avg speed	Avg length
Last 5 Tests	**958**	**20**	**24.6**	**3.08**	**47.9**	**25%**	**82**	**4.37 m**
Career	11,208	196	29.8	3.13	57.2	12%	82	4.37 m

Threat Profile ▶ watch wickets

BEATEN %
6.6%
n=3,552

FALSE-SHOT %
14.2%
beaten + edges

AVG TURN
4.6°
37% ≥5°

AVG DRIFT
2.2°
in-air

How he gets you out	His %	Base	Index
Caught	67%	59%	**1.14×**
Bowled	14%	17%	0.83×
LBW	14%	20%	0.71×
Stumped	5%	4%	**1.06×**

*Share of his 64 wickets by type, indexed against the base rate vs the average spin bowler to LHB (men's Tests). **Index >1** = he does it more than most, **<1** = less. Caught is high for everyone — the signal is the over-indexed row.*

Catches to: Midwicket: deep 7 · Square leg: short leg 6 · Keeper 6 · Slip: 1st 5 · Square leg: regulation 2 · Square leg: backward 2

Angle & variations: Mostly over the wicket (round LHB 16% · RHB 96%)

Stock Ball & Ball Types (vs left-handers) ▶ watch stock balls

Stock ball — full wide outside off, turning in, drifting away, passing outside off (34% of deliveries, economy 4.07). Minor variations: full outside off (25%) and a good length outside off (10%).

Ball type (pitch length × pitching line)	Movement	%	Econ	Wkts	Beaten %
full wide outside off ▶	turning in, drifting away	34%	4.07	21	16%
full outside off ▶	turning in, drifting away	25%	2.92	10	12%
a good length outside off ▶	turning in, drifting away	10%	3.40	8	15%
full on the stumps ▶	turning in, drifting away	8%	2.52	4	8%
a good length wide outside off ▶	turning in, drifting away	8%	4.54	5	20%
full in the channel ▶	turning in, drifting away	5%	3.18	5	10%

*Ball type = pitch-length band × pitching-line region. **Movement** = swing in the air + seam/turn off the pitch, whichever is material, dominant first (ball-tracking, tracked balls only; blank if too few). **Beaten %** = false-shot rate on tracked balls. The stock-ball line above also notes where it passes the stumps.*

New ball vs old ball

New ball (≤30 ov) · 1,329 balls · 18 wkts · econ 3.25

Top ball type	%	Econ	Wkts
full wide outside off	37%	3.57	7
full outside off	25%	2.79	0
a good length outside off	10%	2.88	3
a good length wide outside off	8%	4.29	2

*Most lethal: **full Wide of 6th** (1.7 wkts/100).*

Old ball (31+ ov) · 2,477 balls · 46 wkts · econ 3.65

Top ball type	%	Econ	Wkts
full wide outside off	32%	4.36	14
full outside off	24%	2.99	10
a good length outside off	9%	3.70	5
full on the stumps	9%	2.39	2

*Most lethal: **full 4th stump** (2.7 wkts/100).*

How his ball types and threat shift with ball age (split at 30 overs). Empty side = too few balls in that phase.

Danger Zones (vs left-handers) ▶ watch danger balls

WICKETS — WHERE MOST COME FROM
Full wide outside off
38% of mapped wickets (21 of 56)

RUNS — WHERE MOST CONCEDED
Full wide outside off
35% of runs (689 of 1993)

DANGER LINE
4th stump
6 wkts / 255 balls · 2.2% adj (2.4% raw)

DANGER LENGTH
Good Length
16 wkts / 842 balls · 1.9% adj (1.9% raw)

MOST LETHAL ZONE (BY RATE)
Good Length / 6th stump
5 wkts / 177 balls · 2.5% adj (2.8% raw)

Most threatening pitching a good length in the 4th-stump channel (16 wkts, 1.9% strike). Most wickets come from full wide outside off, while he leaks the most runs full wide outside off.

*Zone shares are over his **mapped** wickets — 8 wickets pitched too full to place on the map (tracked length at/behind the crease), so they sit outside the grid.*

Danger by ball age

NEW BALL (≤30 OV)

full Wide of 6th

most lethal cell · 1.7 wkts/100 · danger length good length · 18 wkts off 1,329 balls

OLD BALL (31+ OV)

full 4th stump

most lethal cell · 2.7 wkts/100 · danger length full · 46 wkts off 2,477 balls

Match-ups (vs left-handers)

New ball vs old ball

Split	Balls	Wkts	Avg	Econ	SR	False%	Med length
New ball (≤30 ov)	1,329	18	39.9	3.25	73.8	14%	4.44 m
Old ball (31+ ov)	2,477	46	32.7	3.65	53.8	14%	4.42 m

By batting position

Split	Balls	Wkts	Avg	Econ	SR	False%	Med length
Top order (1–3)	1,424	12	64.2	3.25	118.7	12%	4.44 m
Middle (4–7)	1,677	26	42.2	3.92	64.5	13%	4.40 m
Tail (8–11)	705	26	13.7	3.03	27.1	22%	4.44 m

Lower average / higher false-shot = the match-up that suits him; higher average = where batters have got on top. Med length = his median pitch length in that split.

Scoring Profile (vs left-handers)

50% of his runs come in boundaries — a boundary every 15 balls; most runs go to the off side (45%); the drive hurts most (47 fours/sixes at 2.4 runs/ball).

BOUNDARY %
50%
runs in 4s/6s

ROTATED %
50%
runs in 1s & 2s

BALLS / BOUNDARY
15

OFF SIDE %
45%
of runs

LEG SIDE %
35%
of runs

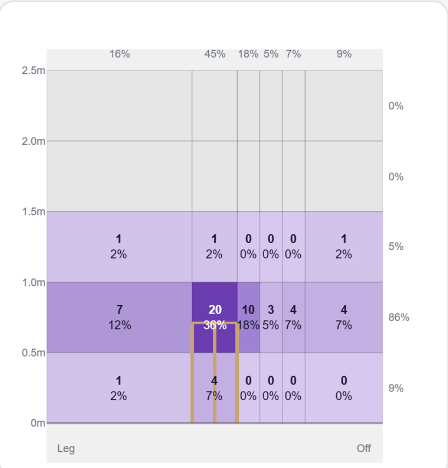
STRAIGHT %
20%
down the ground

Shot type	Balls	Runs	% runs	4s/6s	Runs/ball
Drive	137	332	29%	47	2.42
Sweep	132	309	27%	44	2.34
Work/Nudge	270	296	26%	1	1.10
Slog	35	128	11%	22	3.66
Cut	19	46	4%	6	2.42
Pull/Hook	14	34	3%	6	2.43

Direction from ball-tracking (all scoring shots); shot type recorded on 55% of scoring balls (642/1169) — groups with <5 balls omitted.

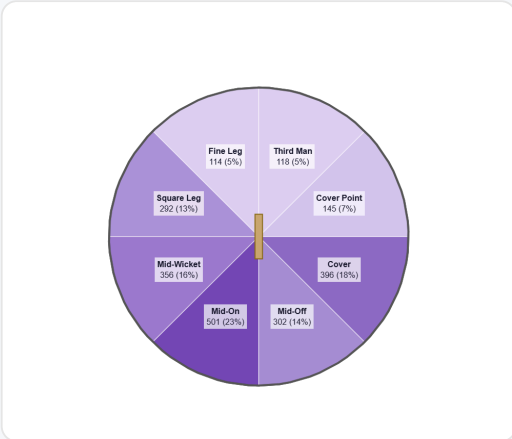
Pitch Maps & Scoring

At the Stumps (wickets)



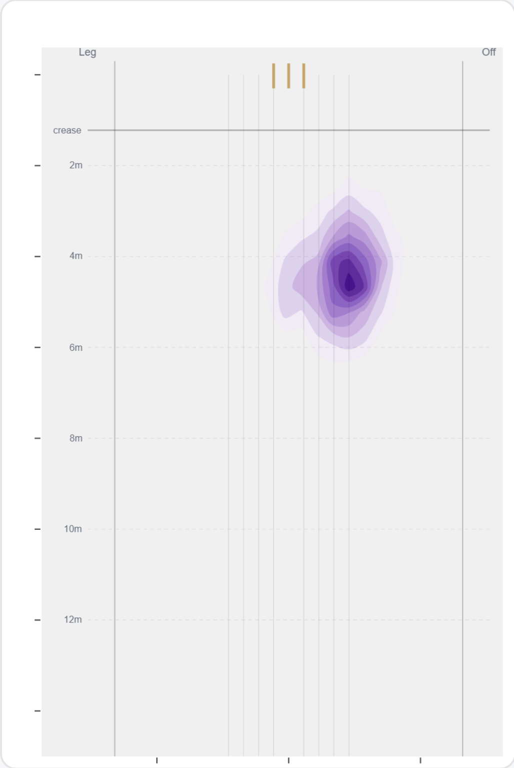
Wicket balls pass the stumps mostly at stumps — pitches around wide of 6th and moves it back.

Where They're Scored Off



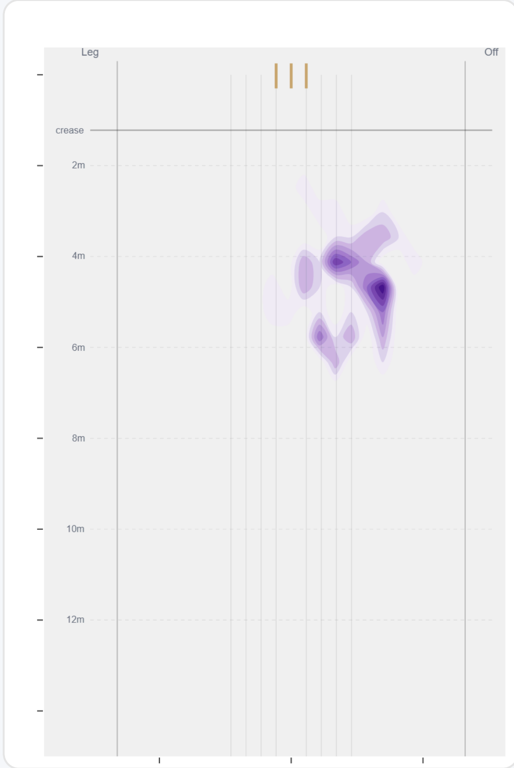
Runs come mostly on the off side (61%).

Where They Pitch It



Pitches it full wide outside off most often (32%); rarely drops short (0%).

Where Wickets Come From

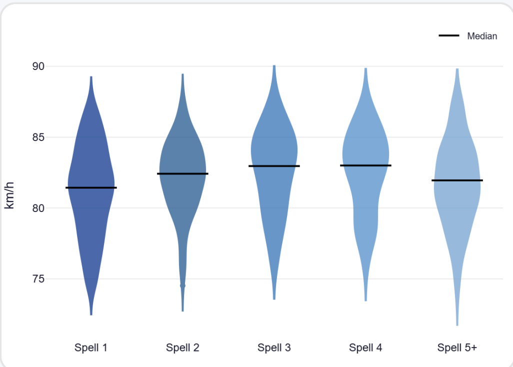


Wickets come mostly from balls pitched full wide outside off, but strikes most often pitching in the 4th-stump channel.

Speed & Spells

He is ~1.9 km/h quicker in later spells, keeps his pace into the 2nd innings, and is as quick on the final day as day one.

Speed by Spell

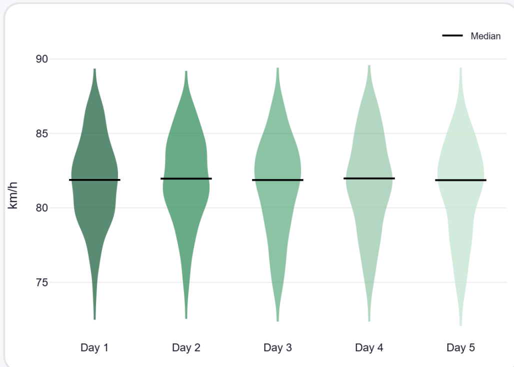


By spell — opening burst vs later spells.

Speed by Innings

1st vs 2nd innings of the match.

Speed by Day



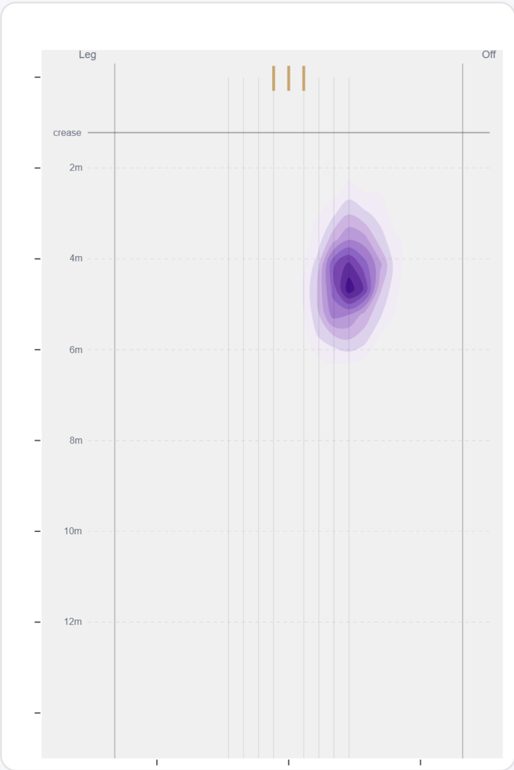
By match day — fatigue across the game.

Over vs Round the Wicket (vs left-handers)

Round the wicket his pitching line moves from wide of 6th to stumps — economy 3.55→3.28, a wicket every 57→80 balls (over→round).

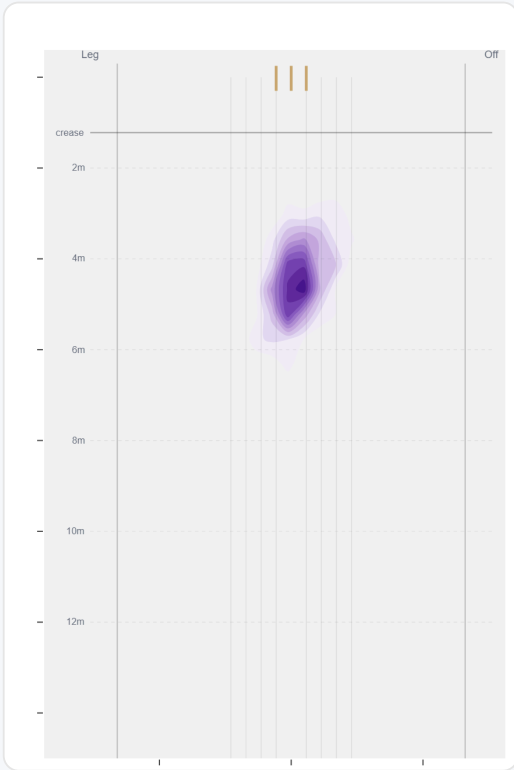
Angle	Balls	Pitch line	Length	Short %	Econ	Wkts	Bdry %
Over	3169 (83%)	Wide of 6th	4.4 m	0%	3.55	56	50%
Round	637 (17%)	Stumps	4.5 m	0%	3.28	8	49%

Over the Wicket



Where he pitches it from over the wicket (3169 balls).

Round the Wicket



Where he pitches it from round the wicket (637 balls).

Sequencing & Over Construction

Relentlessly consistent — repeats his length ball after ball (length spread ±0.9 m; more repeatable than 91% of spin bowlers); holds a steady length right through the over; and holds the same crease position through the over.

Takes his wickets with the stock ball rather than obvious set-ups.

Across 141 dismissals, the wicket ball lands about 27 cm shorter than the ball before it — that's the change that brings the wicket.

Ball in over	Median length	Short %	Econ	Wkt %
Ball 1	4.5 m	0%	4.17	1.4%
Ball 2	4.4 m	0%	3.30	1.4%
Ball 3	4.4 m	0%	3.55	2.8%
Ball 4	4.4 m	0%	3.48	2.1%
Ball 5	4.4 m	0%	3.29	1.7%
Ball 6	4.4 m	0%	3.14	0.7%

Length spread = std-dev of pitch length (smaller = more repeatable). The table shows how his length, scoring and wicket rate shift across the six balls of an over. Set-up lines compare each ball with the previous delivery in the same over (career, all batters).

Release Point & Crease Use

A mid-height release point; releases about 77 cm from the middle stump; varies his spot on the crease a lot (more than 82% of left-arm spin).

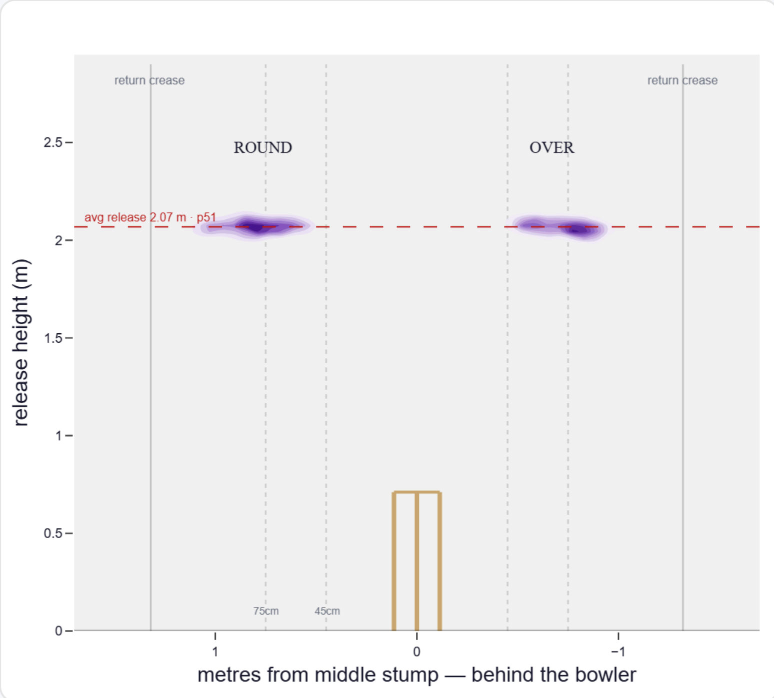
Crease position	% balls	Balls	Econ	Wkts	Avg	SR
Tight (<45cm)	1%	63	1.71	1	18.0	63
Standard (45–75)	41%	4,168	3.06	66	32.2	63
Wide (>75cm)	58%	5,938	3.21	110	28.9	54

How he goes when he releases tight / standard / wide of the middle stump (all release-tracked balls).

Angle	Balls	Tight	Standard	Wide
Over the wicket	30%	2%	50%	48%
Round the wicket	70%	0%	37%	63%

His crease-position mix, split by over vs round. Release data is modern-era (2017+); percentiles vs same hand + type.

Release Point (behind the bowler)



Where he lets the ball go — lateral position × height (purple density). Over and round labelled; dotted lines mark tight/standard/wide and the return creases.

Movement (vs the average spin bowler · vs left-handers)

A big turner of the ball; gets sharp drift in the air.

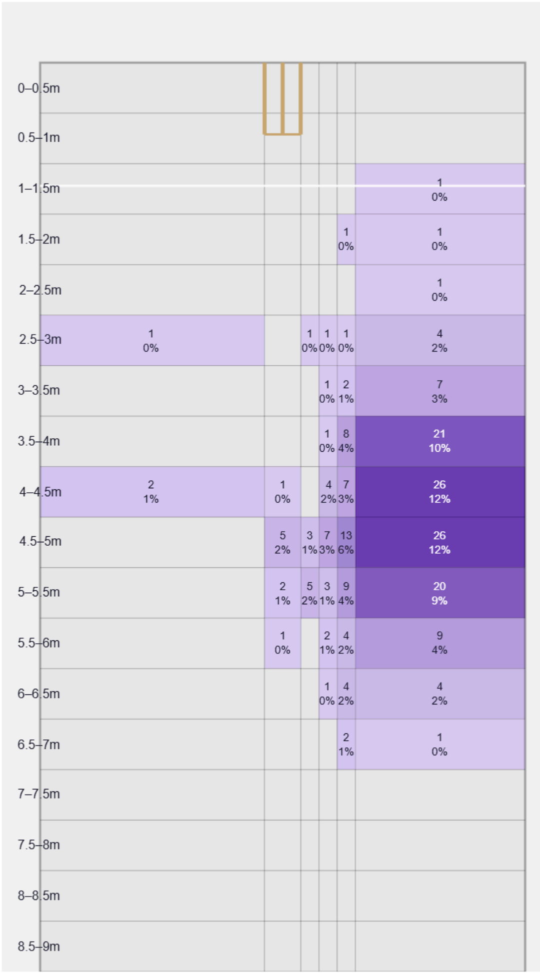
Generates above avg turn and well above avg drift for a spin bowler; turns it in more to left-hand batters (98%).

Percentile vs all Test spin bowlers; direction is which way it moves to this batter. Bounce = extra bounce vs expected.

Movement	Avg	vs average	Direction (vs left-handers)
Drift	2.27°	92nd pct (well above avg)	98% away / 2% in
Turn	4.37°	78th pct (above avg)	2% away / 98% in
Bounce	4.4°	58th pct (about average)	—

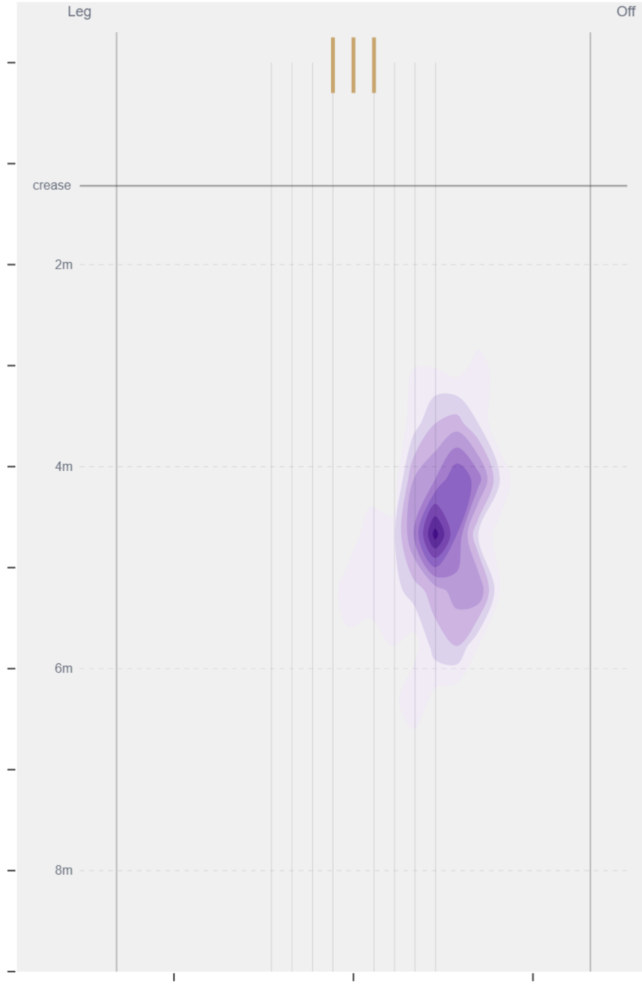
Beaten Zones (play-and-miss)

Beaten — Grid



Length × line where he beats the bat — exact counts per cell.

Beaten — Heatmap



The same play-and-miss density, smoothed, with pitch markings.

Beats the bat most at **Full / Wide of 6th** (39% of play-and-misses). Overall he beats the bat 6.6% of tracked balls (false-shot 14.2%, n=3,552).

Test-match career data. Beaten/false-shot use ~38% shot-quality tracking; turn/drift ~30% ball-tracking. Catches split by fielding position (DeliveryFielders view); some catches have no recorded position. Danger zones use empirical-Bayes shrinkage (≥3 wkts to qualify).